

THE LAST ARRANGEMENT

Written by
Demo Script – Script Continuity Agent

NOTE: This screenplay contains deliberate continuity errors for testing purposes.

FADE IN:

EXT. DOWNTOWN CHICAGO - NIGHT

The city glows under a canopy of streetlights. Steam rises from grates. The sidewalks are wet from an earlier drizzle.

DETECTIVE SARAH MALONE (40s, sharp eyes, world-weary) walks briskly down Michigan Avenue. She wears a long black trench coat and carries a worn leather briefcase.

Her phone buzzes.

SARAH

(answering)

Malone.

DISPATCH (V.O.)

Detective, we've got a body at the Eldridge Hotel. Room 714.

SARAH

On my way.

She hails a cab.

INT. ELDRIDGE HOTEL - LOBBY - NIGHT

Sarah pushes through the revolving doors into a grand, art-deco lobby. Crystal chandeliers cast warm light across marble floors.

OFFICER CHEN (30s, by-the-book) meets her at the elevator bank.

CHEN

Victim is Marcus Webb, 52. Hotel guest. Housekeeping found him two hours ago.

SARAH

Cause of death?

CHEN

Looks like blunt force trauma. ME's upstairs.

They step into the elevator.

EXT. ELDRIDGE HOTEL - ROOFTOP - NIGHT

Sarah steps onto the rooftop terrace. HEAVY RAIN pounds down, drenching her immediately. Lightning cracks across the sky. The wind howls.

She pulls her trench coat tighter against the downpour.

Through the rain, she spots a security camera pointed at the fire escape.

SARAH

(shouting over the storm)

Chen! Get me the footage from this camera. Last 48 hours.

She shields her eyes from the driving rain and looks down at the alley below. A dumpster, a fire escape ladder, and nothing else.

The storm intensifies. Thunder rolls across the lake.

INT. ELDRIDGE HOTEL - ROOM 714 - NIGHT

The hotel room is a crime scene. Yellow tape. Evidence markers. FORENSIC TECH DAVIS dusts for prints.

Marcus Webb lies face-down near the window. Blood pooled beneath his head.

Sarah crouches beside the body. She notices a GOLD POCKET WATCH clutched in Webb's right hand.

SARAH

Davis, bag this watch. And get me a close-up of these scratches on his wrist.

She stands and surveys the room. An open briefcase on the bed. Documents scattered.

SARAH (CONT'D)

Someone was looking for something.

INT. SARAH'S APARTMENT - STUDY - NIGHT

Sarah's home office. Walls covered in case files and photographs. A desk lamp throws a warm pool of light.

She drops her briefcase on a chair and pulls her SERVICE REVOLVER from her shoulder holster. She places the REVOLVER deliberately on the center of her desk, next to a framed photo of her late partner.

SARAH

(to the photo)

Another long one, Jack.

She opens her laptop and begins reviewing Webb's financial records. Her coffee mug sits beside the revolver. The gun's chrome finish catches the lamplight.

She works late into the night, the revolver always within arm's reach on the desk.

INT. ELDRIDGE HOTEL - MANAGER'S OFFICE - DAY

Morning. Sarah sits across from HOTEL MANAGER PATRICIA VOSS (60s, perfectly composed).

VOSS

Mr. Webb had been a guest for three weeks. Always paid in cash. Very private.

SARAH

Any visitors?

VOSS

(hesitating)

There was a woman. Came by twice. Tall, dark hair. I never got her name.

Sarah makes a note in her notebook.

SARAH

I'll need your guest registry for the entire floor. And your staff schedule.

VOSS

Of course, Detective.

INT. SARAH'S APARTMENT - STUDY - NIGHT

Sarah returns to her study. Same desk, same lamp. Nobody has been in the apartment since she left.

The desk is clean and empty – just her laptop and the framed photo. No coffee mug, no papers.

She hears a noise from the hallway. Instinct kicks in.

SARAH

(whispering)

Who's there?

She reaches across the empty desk for her revolver, but her hand finds nothing. She fumbles in the desk drawer instead and pulls out a flashlight.

She moves toward the hallway, flashlight raised.

INT. SARAH'S APARTMENT - HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Sarah edges down the dark hallway, flashlight beam cutting through shadow. The floor creaks under her feet.

At the end of the hall, the front door stands slightly ajar. She didn't leave it open.

She pushes it wide. The corridor outside is empty. A draft of cold air.

She checks the lock. No sign of forced entry.

SARAH

(to herself)

You're losing it, Malone.

She closes and deadbolts the door.

EXT. LAKEFRONT PARK - DAY - FLASHBACK (EARLIER THAT SAME DAY)

FLASHBACK – EARLIER THAT SAME DAY

Bright sunshine bathes the lakefront. Not a cloud in the sky. The water sparkles under clear blue skies. It's a gorgeous, warm afternoon.

Sarah sits on a park bench, sunglasses on, enjoying the unseasonably clear weather. Children play on the grass nearby.

Her phone rings. She squints in the bright sunlight.

SARAH

Malone.

DISPATCH (V.O.)

Detective, we've got a body at the Eldridge Hotel.

The sunny day continues around her as she stands and heads for her car, parked under a clear sky.

END FLASHBACK

INT. POLICE PRECINCT - BULLPEN - DAY

The precinct buzzes with activity. Sarah sits at her desk, reviewing security footage on a monitor.

DETECTIVE RAY OKOYE (50s, her new partner, methodical) drops a file on her desk.

OKOYE

Webb's phone records. Fourteen calls to the same burner in the last week.

SARAH

Can we trace it?

OKOYE

Already on it. And something else – Webb had a storage unit on the south side. Paid up through next year.

Sarah leans back, thinking.

SARAH

Let's get a warrant.

EXT. SOUTH SIDE STORAGE FACILITY - DAY

A sprawling concrete storage complex. Sarah and Okoye pull up in an unmarked car.

Sarah steps out wearing a BRIGHT RED LEATHER JACKET over a white blouse. The jacket is distinctive – cherry red, cropped at the waist.

OKOYE

Nice jacket. New?

SARAH

Birthday present to myself.

They approach Unit 47. Sarah holds up the warrant while Okoye works the bolt cutters on the padlock.

The lock snaps. They slide the door up.

Inside: boxes, a filing cabinet, and a large wall safe.

INT. SOUTH SIDE STORAGE FACILITY - UNIT 47 - MOMENTS LATER

MOMENTS LATER – CONTINUOUS

Sarah, now wearing a BLUE WOOL SWEATER and dark jeans, pulls open the filing cabinet drawers one by one. No red jacket in sight. No explanation for the change.

OKOYE

(reading a document)

Webb was running a shell company. Funneling money through three different banks.

Sarah pulls a thick MANILA ENVELOPE from the bottom drawer. Inside: photographs. Surveillance shots of a woman – the same dark-haired woman from the hotel.

SARAH

(studying the photos)

Who are you?

She flips to the last photo. The woman is standing outside the Eldridge Hotel. The timestamp reads two days before Webb's murder.

OKOYE

We need to find her.

INT. POLICE PRECINCT - CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY

Sarah pins the surveillance photos to a corkboard. Okoye works a laptop.

OKOYE

Got a match. Elena Varga. Import-export business registered in Delaware. Three addresses, all P.O. boxes.

SARAH

She's a ghost.

OKOYE

Not entirely. She made a credit card purchase at a restaurant on Clark Street. Last night.

SARAH

Then she's still in the city.

She grabs her coat.

SARAH (CONT'D)

Let's go have a conversation.

INT. RESTAURANT - CLARK STREET - EVENING

An upscale Italian restaurant, half-empty on a weeknight. Candles on white tablecloths.

Sarah and Okoye find ELENA VARGA (30s, composed, watchful) alone at a corner table, nursing a glass of red wine.

SARAH

Elena Varga?

ELENA

(not surprised)

Detective. I wondered when you'd find me.

Sarah sits across from her.

SARAH

Tell me about Marcus Webb.

ELENA

(carefully)

Marcus was a collector. Of art. Of secrets. Of enemies.

SARAH

And which were you?

Elena smiles but doesn't answer. She takes a slow sip of wine.

EXT. RESTAURANT - CLARK STREET - NIGHT

Sarah and Okoye step out onto the sidewalk. The night air is cold.

OKOYE

She knows more than she's saying.

SARAH

She knows everything. She's just deciding how much to give us.

Sarah's phone buzzes. A text message from an unknown number: "CHECK THE WATCH."

She stares at it. The gold pocket watch from Webb's hand.

SARAH

Ray, we need to go back to evidence lockup. Now.

They hurry to the car as the city lights reflect off the wet pavement.

FADE OUT.

THE END